A Series of Helpful Post-it Notes I Left Around the House for My Husband This Week

By Jenny Lawson

INTRODUCTION

Okay, so I was looking for relationship ideas and I came across a website that suggested leaving post-it notes with special little messages for your spouse, just (air quotes) "to let him know that you are thinking of him." What I wonderful idea! We are both so busy we often don't have time to sit down and talk to each other. So I rifled through the junk drawer and found a nice pad of post-it notes . . . let the relationship-building begin!!

A Series of Helpful Post-it Notes I Left Around the House for My Husband This Week . . . from Let's Pretend This Never Happened by Jenny Lawson

EDUCATIONAL

Dear Victor: This bath towel was wet and you left it on the floor and it was the last clean one in the house. I'm pretty sure this is how tuberculosis is

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spread. I'm writing all this in my blog in case I end up dead because of your carelessness.

Dear Victor: There is a pile of business suits for the dry cleaner's that have been in the closet for five months. You work from home. [WTF?], Victor?

Dear Victor: Why is cleaning up cat vomit always my job? Was I not here when we picked from the job jar? Is there a job jar at all? Because I'd like to redraw. Also, I'm aware that you always have to clean out the litter box, but that's because at any moment my IUD could fail and I could accidentally get pregnant and then get that cat-poop pregnancy disease, and our baby would be born with no arms or legs. Is that what you want, Victor? For our baby not to have arms? You are so selfish.

Dear Victor: You make me sick. Why in God's name wouldn't you just throw away the empty pizza box

when you were done with it? Are your arms broken? Do you have some sort of disease I don't know about that makes you blind to empty pizza boxes?

Dear Victor: Okay, I just remembered I was the last one to make pizza, so I guess I left this box out. Still, I'm leaving out the note anyway so you can learn from it. Bad, bad Victor.

Dear Victor: I do not appreciate your leaving passive-aggressive addendums to my helpful Post-it notes. In fact, they are the opposite of helpful. They are just bitter.

Dear Victor: If you leave wet towels on the ground again I will stab you.

Dear Victor: You can't take clothes out of the dryer without telling me and just dump them on the bed in a heap. When I find them they've usually cooled

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off, and then I have to put them all back in the dryer with a cup of water, and then rerun the dryer so all the wrinkles come out, and then sneak each article of clothing out one at a time and hang it up. It's called "a method," Victor. Stop judging me.

Dear Victor: No, actually, I don't know how to use an iron. Because we don't own one. How have you never noticed this before?! The dryer is our iron, Victor. Also, I would appreciate it if you would talk to me directly instead of yelling at me on a Post-it. These Post-its are for educational purposes. Not to draw lewd caricatures of hands pointing menacingly at me. Also, you're supposed to point with your index finger. This is basic pointing etiquette.

Dear Victor: I've poisoned something in the fridge. Good luck with that.

Dear Victor: I'm sorry. I think I might have PMS. I don't know what's wrong with me.

Dear Victor: That was an apology, you a**h***! Now there are two things poisoned in the fridge. Because you don't know how to accept an apology.

Dear Victor: I am so sorry you are sick. I swear I was just kidding about poisoning s*** in the fridge. I mean, I did leave the yogurt out for, like, a half a day, but that was really more by accident because I was so distracted by the wet towel on the floor. If anything, you brought this on yourself. Once again, I apologize.

Dear Victor: I love you but I'm getting kind of weak from hunger, and I know you said you didn't poison anything, but every time I take a bite of something you leer and laugh suspiciously and I have to spit it out. I can only assume this is

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probably how Gandhi felt when he wasn't allowed to eat. (Here's a hint: He felt stabby.)

Dear Victor: Okay, first of all, you don't know that Gandhi went on a hunger strike on purpose. For all we know he was avoiding poisoning too. The people who survive are the ones who write the history, Victor. Not the people who die of hunger because their husbands may or may not have poisoned all the food in the house. Except guess what? This is all going on my blog, so I can document this in case people find my emaciated body later and demand justice. There will be a reckoning and it will be brutal and swift.

Dear Victor: Great. Now we're out of Post-its. I'm writing this on the towel you left on the ground this morning, since we obviously have no respect for towels anymore. I'm going to the grocery store for more Post-its, and I'm going to eat unpoisoned Triscuits straight out of the box while I'm there,

so I will return fresh and renewed. Also, the cat vomited in the hall and I am not cleaning it up. I have had enough, Victor. And so has the cat. Whom I'm assuming you poisoned.

Dear Victor: The cat and I are leaving you. You can have the dog. Also, I've decided not to go get Post-it notes after all, because I'm no longer speaking with you, so I'm just writing this on your hand towel. You will never hear from me again.

Dear Victor: The dog started whining when I told him he had to stay with you, so I'm taking him too.

Dear Victor: Yes, actually I was holding a bag of dog treats when I told him he had to stay with you, but I don't think that had anything to do with his reaction. Also, we're running out of dish towels, so this will be my last message to you.

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Dear Victor: Okay. Fine. You can have the dog. I tried to put him in the car and he peed on me. You two deserve each other. I am writing this on the dog because it seemed fitting. Also I couldn't find packing peanuts for the booze, so I just drank it all. YOU WILL MISS ME SO MUCH ONCE I'M SOBER ENOUGH TO WAKE UP AND DRIVE AWAY.

Dear Victor: Wow. That . . . really got out of hand. I'm sending this cat in as a peace offering. I forgive you for all the stuff you wrote on the walls about my sister, and I'm going to just ignore all the stuff you wrote about my "giant ass" (turn cat over for rest) because I love you and you need me. Who else loves you enough to send you notes written on cats? Nobody, that's who. Also, I stapled a picture of us from our wedding day to the cat's left leg. Don't we look happy? We can be that way again. Just stop leaving wet towels on the floor. That's all I ask. I'm low-maintenance that

way. Also, this cat needs to go on a diet. I shouldn't be able to write this much on a cat and still have room left over.

Epilogue: Victor forgave me and we all lived happily ever after, except for the cat, who had to have his leg amputated, but that was less from the infection and more from his poor circulation because he was so fat. He kind of brought it on himself too. But now he's less fat. By, like, a whole leg.

(Disclaimer: Most of this was exaggerated, except for the part where Victor left a wet towel on the floor. That totally happened. I'm still working through it.)

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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